



Super Green Farm — Poultry Manual

This manual is a practical, step-by-step guide for running a small–medium poultry operation at **Super Green Farm**. Adjust numbers (stocking density, feed amounts, medication) to match your breed, housing, and local veterinary advice.

1) Goals and standards

- **Core goals:** healthy birds, low mortality, good growth/lay rate, clean eggs/meat, and consistent records.
- **Key performance indicators (KPIs):**
 - Mortality (% per week)
 - Feed intake (kg/day) and **FCR** (broilers)
 - Average weight by week (broilers)
 - Egg production rate (%) and egg quality (layers)
 - Water intake (L/day)
 - Vaccination/medication completion

2) Farm layout and biosecurity

2.1 Biosecurity rules (non-negotiable)

- Keep poultry area **separate** from other animals and visitors.
- **Footbath** at every house entrance (refresh daily).
- Dedicated boots/overalls per poultry area.
- Handwashing or sanitizer before/after entering.
- Control rodents and wild birds (mesh, bait stations, no spilled feed).
- Quarantine new birds **14 days** before mixing.

2.2 House design basics

- Dry, well-drained site; avoid standing water.
- Good airflow without direct drafts on chicks.
- Easy cleaning: smooth floor, washable walls if possible.
- Reliable lighting and safe electrical setup.

2.3 Stocking density (guide)

- **Broilers:** 10–12 birds/m² (adjust for heat; reduce density in hot months).
- **Layers:** 6–8 birds/m² on deep litter, or per cage system specs.

3) Breed and production type

Choose one main system (or separate houses):

- **Broilers (meat):** fast growth, short cycle (5–8 weeks depending on strain/market).

- **Layers (eggs):** longer cycle (start laying ~18–22 weeks).
- **Dual purpose:** slower growth and fewer eggs, but resilient.

4) Receiving chicks / pullets

4.1 Before arrival checklist

- House cleaned, washed, and disinfected.
- Litter dry and deep enough (5–10 cm).
- Brooder heat working and checked.
- Feed and clean water ready.
- Record book ready.

4.2 On arrival

- Count birds; note any weak/dead.
- Provide **warm water immediately**.
- First 24 hours: keep feed easily accessible (trays/paper) and observe closely.

5) Brooding management (0–4 weeks)

5.1 Temperature (guide)

- Week 1: ~32–34°C at chick level
- Reduce ~2–3°C each week until ~24–26°C

Chick behavior tells you the truth:

- Huddling = cold
- Far from heat + panting = too hot
- Even spread + quiet peeping = correct

5.2 Lighting (guide)

- First 2–3 days: near-continuous light to help find feed/water.
- Then maintain a consistent schedule suitable for your program.

5.3 Litter and hygiene

- Keep litter **dry and loose**.
- Remove wet patches daily (around drinkers).

6) Feeding and nutrition

6.1 Feed types

Broilers

- Starter (0–2/3 weeks)
- Grower (3–5 weeks)
- Finisher (last 1–2 weeks)

Layers

- Chick starter (0–6/8 weeks)

- Grower/developer (8–18 weeks)
- Layer mash/pellet (from point-of-lay)

6.2 General feeding rules

- Buy quality feed from trusted suppliers; store in a dry, cool place.
- Use **FIFO** (first in, first out).
- Prevent mold: never use feed with bad smell, clumps, or visible fungus.

6.3 Water management

- Clean water is as important as feed.
- Wash drinkers daily; flush lines if using nipples.
- If safe and locally recommended, sanitize water periodically.

7) Vaccination and health program

Vaccines and drugs vary by country and disease pressure. Work with a local veterinarian/extension officer to finalize the schedule.

7.1 Daily health check (walk-through)

- Check appetite and water use.
- Look for coughing, sneezing, nasal discharge.
- Check droppings (diarrhea, blood).
- Observe movement (lameness).
- Check mortality and remove dead birds immediately.

7.2 Common diseases (quick guide)

- **Newcastle disease:** sudden deaths, respiratory signs, nervous signs.
- **Gumboro (IBD):** depression, diarrhea, high mortality in young birds.
- **Coccidiosis:** bloody diarrhea, weakness, uneven growth.
- **CRD (Mycoplasma):** chronic coughing, slow growth.
- **Fowl pox:** scabs on comb/wattles, reduced feed intake.

7.3 When to call a vet immediately

- Rapid increase in deaths.
- Blood in droppings.
- Many birds refusing feed/water.
- Severe breathing problems.

8) Environment, ventilation, and heat stress

- Provide shade and airflow.
- Avoid overcrowding.
- In hot weather:
 - Add extra drinkers.
 - Feed during cooler hours.

- Consider electrolytes/vitamins if advised.
- Reduce stress (noise, handling).

9) Cleaning, disinfection, and waste management

9.1 Routine cleaning

- Daily: remove wet litter, clean around feeders/drinkers.
- Weekly: scrape buildup, check corners, dust surfaces.

9.2 Turnaround (between flocks)

1. Remove all birds.
2. Remove litter and manure.
3. Wash with detergent.
4. Disinfect (approved product).
5. Dry fully.
6. Rest the house (downtime) if possible.

9.3 Manure handling

- Compost manure away from poultry houses.
- Keep runoff out of water sources.

10) Egg handling (layers)

- Collect eggs **2–4 times/day** (more in hot weather).
- Keep eggs clean and dry; avoid washing unless necessary.
- Store in a cool place, pointed end down.
- Record daily egg count and rejects (cracked/dirty).

11) Broiler marketing and slaughter planning

- Target market weight and age based on buyer demand.
- Withhold feed for a short period before transport (do **not** deny water).
- Transport in cool hours; avoid overcrowding in crates.

12) Records and forms (templates)

Keep simple, consistent records.

12.1 Daily flock record (copy/paste table)

Date	Age (days)	Birds alive	Deaths	Feed used (kg)	Water (L)	Notes / signs

12.2 Medication / vaccination log

Date	Flock	Product	Dose & method	Reason	Start	End	Withdrawal (meat/eggs)

13) SOPs (standard operating procedures)

13.1 Morning routine

- Check temperature/ventilation.
- Check water first.
- Provide feed.
- Collect eggs (layers).
- Remove dead birds.
- Quick health scan and notes.

13.2 Evening routine

- Top up water/feed.
- Collect eggs.
- Secure house (predators, rodents).

14) Emergency procedures

- **Disease outbreak:** isolate house, restrict movement, inform vet, enhance disinfection.
 - **Power failure:** backup light/heat for chicks, increase ventilation.
 - **Water failure:** emergency water storage and manual drinkers.
 - **Predator attack:** reinforce doors/mesh, night security.
-

Appendix A: Starter shopping list

- Brooder/heat source + thermometer
- Feeders and drinkers (enough to prevent crowding)
- Footbath + disinfectant
- Litter (wood shavings/rice husk)
- Record book or sheets
- First aid basics (as advised)

Appendix B: Quick troubleshooting

- Wet litter → reduce leaks, add dry litter, improve ventilation.
- Slow growth → check feed quality, density, disease, temperature.
- High mortality in chicks → brooding temperature, water access, transport stress, infection.
- Drop in egg production → feed, lighting, heat stress, disease, mites.